



HARVESTING

Kohlrabi is best harvested when its stems have reached the size of tennis balls, although some varieties are still worth eating if left in the ground to grow larger. Cut them at the root and remove the oldest leaves; leaving young leaves will help to keep it fresh. If the weather is mild, kohlrabi can be left in the ground in winter, but lift if frosts are forecast.

STORING

Kohlrabi can be stored in boxes full of moist sand but it is best eaten fresh, so sow successively to ensure a continuous crop.

PESTS AND DISEASES

Kohlrabi is susceptible to attack from cabbage root fly, flea beetles, aphids, and slugs and snails (see pp.246-7). Since the leaves are not eaten, some damage might be tolerable. A bigger problem is clubroot; dig up and destroy affected plants and rotate crops.



Some leaf damage can be tolerated.